CIRC HQ STUDENT HANDOUT | GRADE 5

Accessibility Design Sprint

Goal: Design and test a small prototype that reduces a specific barrier involving reach, grip, vision, hearing, movement, or attention.

35 minutes | 8 steps | Engineering and Design | Playbook A meeting 18, grade 5 path

Ask | Plan | Build | Test | Improve

You are done when

Deliver a 30-second pitch that names the user goal, barrier, access test, result, and revision.

You will use

- Accessibility user cards
- Paper
- Cardboard
- Tape
- Craft materials
- Large-print labels
- Feedback cards
- Timer
- Scissors
- Access-test cards

Steps

35 minutes total. Your teacher says when to move on.

1 Step 1: Get ready — 3 min

- Choose one provided user card.
- Read the user goal aloud.

2 Step 2: Design safely — 4 min

- Use only the facts on the user card.
- Cut only on the table.
- Keep fingers outside the cutting path.
- Carry scissors closed.

3 Step 3: Name the problem — 5 min

- Name the tool or space problem.
- Sketch three possible changes.
- Circle one idea.

4 Step 4: Build one feature — 8 min

- Cut only the planned shapes.
- Build the smallest useful feature.
- Add a large clear label.

5 Step 5: Run the card test — 6 min

- Use the provided test card.
- Observe one access task.
- Record where the task stops.

6 Step 6: Fix the problem — 4 min

- Change one blocked feature.
- Repeat the same card test.

7 Step 7: Reset the sprint — 2 min

- Close the scissors.
- Store the prototype with its card.

8 Step 8: Exit check — 3 min

- Write what became easier.
- Write what remains difficult.

What to turn in

A 30 second pitch: user goal, barrier, test, result, change.

No computer? Another way to do it

Draw the prototype and pitch from the drawing.

Finished early? Next challenge

Second User: Test with a different user and identify one need the first test did not reveal.

Stay safe

Simulate barriers only through the provided user card. Never restrain, blindfold, label, or imitate a disability, and stop any unsafe user test.

Stuck? Try this order

1. Read the step again, out loud if you can.
2. Ask a partner at your table.
3. Raise your hand. Keep working on the next part while you wait.